How to vibe *code*

Vibe coding is building software by describing it. On Foldo you say what you want in plain words, watch the app build in your browser, then share a link. The skill is in how you ask.



> *Forget that the code even exists.”*
>
> ANDREJ KARPATHY, WHO COINED THE TERM, 2025

THE METHOD FIVE PRINCIPLES

1

One person, one job.

Before you type, finish this sentence: *who* wants to *do what*, so that *why*. “A student wants to see where their money goes, so they stop running short.” Build your first message around it.

2

Start from a template.

Pick the one for your track: Payments, Access to Finance, or Fraud and Security. It already works, so your first message improves something real.

3

One change, fully described.

Ask for one thing, then look. Name the screen, the button and the words on it. Give sample numbers. Say what to keep: “Leave the chart as it is.” Messages are limited each day, and the counter sits under the prompt box. Stuck for words? Press Enhance prompt, then edit what it writes.

4

Test it like a user.

Click through the preview. Does the main action work? Did anything else change? When it works, press Download zip to keep a copy.

5

Keep it fake.

Use made-up names and amounts. Never paste real card numbers, passwords or secret keys. Anyone with your link can open the app, no sign-in needed.

TROUBLESHOOTING

When it breaks

Error?
Press Fix this error.

Still broken?
Paste the exact error and say what you clicked just before.

Reply cut off?
Send “continue”.

Going in circles?
After two failed fixes, ask it to undo the last change and explain the problem in plain words.

THE PROMPT

Vague vs clear

VAGUE

“Make a budgeting app.”

CLEAR

“For students who run short before the month ends. Home screen: money left this month in large type, then a bar chart of spending by category (rent, food, transport, going out). Add a form to log a purchase: amount, category, date. Use 20 sample purchases. Keep the template’s header and colours.”

THE FIRST HALF HOUR FROM BLANK PAGE TO SHARED LINK

00:00
Pick a template. Write your sentence.

05:00
First change: the main screen, with sample data.

15:00
Add the one action that matters. Test it.

25:00
Download zip. Share, then open the link in a private window to see what others see.